LucidFlow
Every Click Flawless. Every Journey Compliant.

AI POWERED CONTINUOUS DARK PATTERN MONITORING

Dark Pattern Assessment Report

Automated Scanning. Continuous governance. Evidence-led findings.

PREPARED FOR

royalsundaram.in

Assessment scope

royalsundaram.in (1 page)

REPORT ID	VERSION	ISSUE DATE
LF-ROYALSUNDARAM-2026-001	V1.0	26th October 2026

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02 / EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Decision-ready overview

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PAGES / SCREENS ASSESSED	POTENTIAL FINDINGS	HIGH / CRITICAL	REVALIDATED CLOSED

Pattern distribution

Executive assessment

OVERALL POSTURE

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Priority themes

CHOICE ARCHITECTURE	PRICE & DISCLOSURE	CONSENT & DATA
The presentation of terms and consent options can influence users to proceed without fully distinguishing essential requirements from optional permissions.	Bundled acceptance of terms and promotional communication consent can limit users' ability to make independent, informed choices.	Customer interactions should provide clear information, meaningful choices and transparent consent mechanisms to support a fair and user-friendly experience.

ABOUT DARK PATTERNS

What are dark patterns?

Dark patterns are user-interface designs or digital practices that are intentionally created to mislead, manipulate, coerce or otherwise impair a consumer's ability to make free, informed and autonomous choices. They may influence a customer to purchase a product, share personal information, accept marketing communication, select an add-on, remain enrolled in a paid service or make another decision that primarily benefits the platform rather than the customer.

For customer journeys across numerous industries, dark-pattern risks may arise during product discovery, quotation, add-on selection, proposal submission, payment, renewal, servicing, cancellation and communication-consent processes. The assessment of a dark pattern should consider the full customer journey, the wording, default settings, timing, prominence of choices, data requested and the practical ability to decline or exit.

The taxonomy is aligned with the categories identified in the CCPA Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023. IRDAI, RBI-regulated entities and other digital platforms involved in financial transactions (Example: E-commerce) should also assess these practices against applicable customer-protection, disclosure, consent, grievance-handling and fair-conduct requirements. A finding in this report is an operational assessment of potential risk in a customer facing journey.

Dark-pattern categories

No.	Pattern	Definition
1	**False Urgency**	Creating a false or misleading impression of urgency or scarcity to pressure an immediate decision.
2	**Basket Sneaking**	Adding products, services, riders, add-ons or charges to a customer's cart or checkout without the customer's explicit consent.
3	**Confirm Shaming**	Using guilt, shame, fear or emotionally loaded language to pressure a customer into accepting an option or avoiding an opt-out.
4	**Forced Action**	Requiring a customer to complete unrelated actions or provide unnecessary information to access a product, service or basic functionality.
5	**Subscription Trap**	Making cancellation, withdrawal, non-renewal or termination of a recurring service intentionally difficult, unclear or burdensome.
6	**Interface Interference**	Manipulating the visual design, presentation, hierarchy or default state of interface elements to favor an option that benefits the platform.
7	**Bait and Switch**	Advertising a specific product, benefit or price but presenting a different, less favourable or higher-cost outcome later in the journey.
8	**Drip Pricing**	Revealing mandatory charges, fees or unavoidable costs only late in the purchase or payment journey rather than presenting them upfront.
9	**Disguised Advertisement**	Designing advertising, promotional content or sponsored recommendations to resemble neutral information, system messages or ordinary content.
10	**Nagging**	Repeatedly interrupting or prompting a customer to take a particular action after they have declined, dismissed or deferred it.
11	**Trick Wording**	Using confusing, vague, misleading or double-negative language that makes it difficult for a customer to understand the consequence of a choice.
12	**SaaS Billing / Unsolicited Billing**	Charging a customer without clear, informed and transparent authorization, including obscuring recurring-payment or paid-renewal terms.
13	**Rogue Malware / Scareware**	Using fake security warnings, misleading alerts or deceptive pop-ups to pressure a customer into paying, downloading software or sharing credentials.